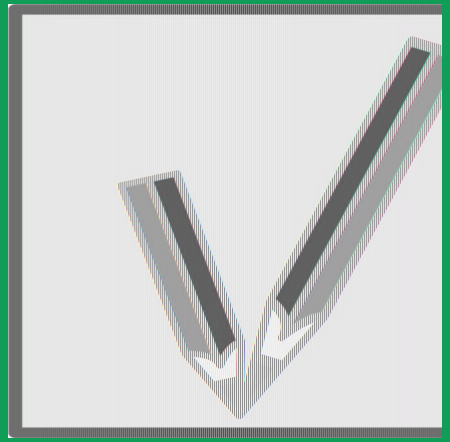
Village

~Students Helping Students~



Middle school students are falling behind.

Village aims to bolster the quality of middle school education by connecting them with college students who are ready to help.

Problem

- Middle school students are being left behind due to a **lack of supplemental educational resources.**
  - Existing solutions: either too costly or not effective enough

- **College students** are potential **resources**, but are **untapped.**
  - “Experts” in certain subjects, but not asked to teach

- **No effective channels to connect** college students and middle school teachers

Solution: Village

"It takes a village to raise a child..."

- **Village**
  - an **educational website service**
    - provides customized support for middle school teachers
    - matches a qualified college student as a teaching assistant to a middle school teacher in need of support
- **Services** provided by the **matched teaching assistant** include:
  - Help with grading and analyzing work patterns in the class
  - Tutoring for groups and individuals
  - Educational materials as requested by the teacher

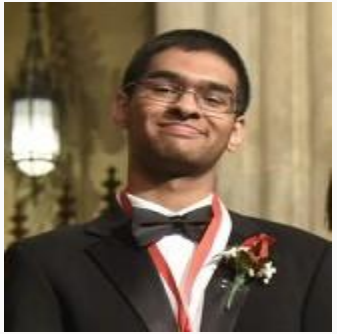
Market

- The **users** of Village are:
  - Middle school teachers of a school partnered with Village
  - College students - volunteer teaching assistants

- The **decision makers** in buying Village services are:
  - Middle school faculty
  - School district administrators

- **Serviceable Available Market** of $63,216,000
  - There are 15,804 middle schools in the United States (*Education Week*).
  - Each school would be charged $4000 for a year contract.

Our Village Team



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- **The *Village* Team**:
  - 5 Fairfield University Computer Science students in multiple roles:
    - software developers, project managers, and community outreach
  - Consultants:
    - College professors of Computer Science Department
      - Dr. Adrian Rusu and Prof. Jonathan Wilson

Challenges We've Overcome

- Time management with scheduling meeting times
- Complex assignments
  - Building an SRS and DDD from scratch
- Learning to use new technology
  - Draw.io, Excel, Adobe XD
- Different skill sets needed, but we assigned tasks to appropriate team members

Future Challenges/ Plan

- **Areas that we need assistance with:**
  - <u>Education System Knowledge</u>
    - Understanding the middle school and college systems
    - Connections in the field
  - <u>Marketing and Business</u>
    - Evaluating new business ideas and financial plan
    - Strategies for marketing campaigns
  - <u>Data security</u>
    - Our system must remain secure and protect users' data
    - Need cybersecurity expert
- **Plan for next Semester:**
  - Attending Fairfield StartUp
  - Implement MVP

Video Demo of Village System

- A simple example of how the Village website will function…

- **Video demo:**
  https://drive.google.com/file/d/1ofAhwYxDQPsousXjs-tgleidZeqAgYMI/view?resourcekey

Reflections

- Different members had different proficiencies which we put to work in the right places.
- Learned about the best practices of Software Development
- This complex project definitely showed the benefits of good teamwork.
- Learned a lot of non-technical skills, like planning and project management.

Thank you! Questions?